before publishing, I agreed to let *Channel 4 News* send round an interviewer to the Guardian, who would be going live with the story on their website at 9.30 p.m. Channel 4 would go out with a story on their late bulletin at 10.30 p.m. But by now the *Guardian*, too, were bellowing their own tune, not thinking 'This is all to the greater good', but 'What about our exclusivity!?', 'What about our credit!?' The television people were not just television people, they were led by Stephen Grey, a journalist with vast experience in the area who had written a much-admired book about Afghanistan and who the *Guardian* had wished to work for them. Grey had always been on the periphery of our plans, though the *Guardian* later claimed we brought in Grey as a competitor to them. This was nonsense, but for some reason it galled the *Guardian*. They had got themselves into a position of worrying about their credit and their slice of the pie, and this was not only inappropriate, it was troubling, given that my whole relationship with the special investigations reporter was based on the idea that he was an activist who really cared about the material. The *Guardian* would say I was difficult and obstructive, but this was merely part of the bitching and hissyness that make Britain's premier liberal paper the thing we know and love.

Still, the results were impressive. Seventeen pages in *Der Spiegel*, some thirteen in the *Guardian* and eight in the *New York Times*. The reaction was instant and massive: each of these papers found themselves, for the first time in a long while, at the forefront of a discussion as to the real nature of modern warfare. I was thrown into a maelstrom of publicity and I attended to it as best I could, keeping to the plan, citing the material, pointing all the while to the larger issues of press freedom. You can always tell, however, when you're working with people hungry for more than the upholding of the principle will supply. The *Guardian* people couldn't stop themselves from yacking at their dinner parties, and the senior news reporter, especially, couldn't keep his mouth shut, endlessly wanting to tell everyone his 'how we did it' story. I don't think he ever quite understood the security implications, and he was always looking to big himself up with his colleagues, which is presumably why he blabbed to the *New York Times* about the cables we were holding. As part of his showing off, he let it be known that I had stayed at his house and at the other reporter's house, even though that was a dangerous thing to reveal.